

INTERN OPERATING GUIDE

Edward Agent Stack

A public-safe setup for interns who use Codex first, keep project context written down, and escalate to Edward only with options and evidence.

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Source: [giaphutran12/edward-agent-stack](#)

Secrets rule: never inspect, print, diff, or summarize local real env values.

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01 · What This Repo Is

Edward Agent Stack is not a private memory dump. It is a public-safe operating system for interns: stable engineering defaults, per-project context, dated decisions, and install scripts.

Edward Rules

Stable defaults for how Edward wants interns and agents to think: Codex first, source-backed, Postgres-first, no casual destructive work.

Project Notes

Current facts and priorities for one project. This is where “what matters right now” lives.

Decision Notes

Dated receipts. If Edward made a reusable decision, Codex writes it down so the same question does not come back next week.

02 · Fresh Mac Install

Paste the block below into Codex on a fresh Mac. The intern should not hand-install random tools first. Let Codex run the repo scripts, fix safe missing dependencies, and report what is blocked.

```
Install Edward's agent stack on this fresh MacBook. Clone https://github.com/giaphutran12/edward-agent-stack to ~/edward-agent-stack, read AGENTS.md, then run ./scripts/bootstrap-macos.sh, ./scripts/install.sh, ./scripts/verify.sh, and ./scripts/auth-doctor.sh. Use /caveman ultra for terse token-saving communication. Install prerequisites automatically when safe: Xcode Command Line Tools prompt, Homebrew, Node/npm/npn, Bun, Python/pip/uv, GitHub CLI, ripgrep, jq, tmux, ffmpeg, Supabase CLI, Vercel CLI, Claude Code, Nia CLI, Repowise, Caveman, Edward skills, and giaphutran12/codex-gstack for Codex using ./setup --host codex. Do not inspect or print local real env/secret files. If a tool needs login, API key, license acceptance, or a GUI first-run step, stop and tell me exactly what is missing instead of forcing it.
```

1. `./scripts/bootstrap-macos.sh`: Xcode Command Line Tools, Homebrew, shell path, Rosetta when needed.
2. `./scripts/install.sh`: core CLIs, skills, Edward gstack fork, MCP template.

- 3. `./scripts/verify.sh`: binary/file sanity check.
- 4. `./scripts/auth-doctor.sh`: safe auth report without printing secrets.

03 · Tool Stack

Layer	Default	Why
Primary agent	Codex	Interns ask Codex first with full repo/task context.
Workflow	Caveman, Edward Rules, gstack	Short communication, stable defaults, investigate/ship paths.
Repo context	Repowise, ripgrep	Orient before editing; search fast.
Memory/ research	MemPalace, Nia, Exa	Durable agent memory, indexed context, current web research.
Shipping	GitHub, Vercel, Supabase CLI	PRs, deploy inspection, migrations/project management.
Runtime basics	Docker, Python/uv, Bun/Node, jq, tmux	Local services, scripts, JS/TS apps, JSON, long sessions.

Not default Notion, TinyFish, OMX, Kiro, `mlx_whisper`, Bitwarden.

04 · Auth Gates And Secrets

Installer can install binaries. It cannot create accounts, approve OAuth, accept licenses, or invent API keys.

Tool	Command / Gate	Note
Codex	<code>codex login</code>	Primary coding agent.
GitHub	<code>gh auth login --web</code>	Clone, push, PRs, issues.
Vercel	<code>vercel login</code>	Deploy and project inspection.
Supabase	<code>supabase login</code>	Migrations and project management.
Nia	<code>nia auth login</code>	Indexed repo/docs/context search.
Exa	local EXA_API_KEY	Keep in local Codex config only.
Repowise Gemini	<code>.repowise/.env</code>	Local ignored project file. Never print it.

Bitwarden is not default. A password manager avoids Slack-pasting, but cannot stop a trusted intern or local agent from copying a raw key after access is granted. Use per-user accounts, scoped/staging keys, ignored local env files, logs, revocation, and rotation.

05 · Daily Workflow

1. Load `/caveman ultra`.
2. Load `$edward-rules`.
3. Read the project `PROJECT.md`, recent decision notes, and `AGENTS.local.md` if present.
4. Ask Codex first. Understand the options and blast radius before escalating.
5. Before PR/end of meaningful work, run decision capture and update project notes if context changed.

Default answer

Did you ask Codex? What did Codex say?

06 · GStack, Repowise, Escalation

GStack

```
git clone --single-branch --depth 1 https://github.com/giaphutran12/codex-gstack.git
~/gstack/repos/gstack
cd ~/gstack/repos/gstack
./setup --host codex
```

Use `gstack investigate` before saying stuck. Use `gstack ship` for PR/review/shipping flow.

Repowise

```
./scripts/repowise-update.sh /path/to/project --provider gemini
```

Repowise is for repo/code orientation, not Edward Rules. It helps reduce context waste before agents make changes.

Escalation Template

Edward, need decision.

Question:

Context:

What Codex said:

Options:

A)

B)

C)

Tradeoff:

Risk/blast radius:

What I tested:

My recommendation:

Bring options, not chaos. Include why repo/docs/internet/Codex cannot answer it.